

# Lesson 3 – Purpose and Service (1 hour)

Module: Understanding Purpose in Life (UPL) | Course: Youth Impact Training Programme (YITP)

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|--------------------|--------------|
| Content Type       | Text Content |
| Estimated Duration | 60 minutes   |
| Mandatory          | Yes          |
| Published          | Yes          |

## Learning Objectives

- Objective: See how purpose is linked to serving others.

## Lesson Content

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Key Topics

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Core Lesson

about helping others climb.

Let's break it down.

### 1. The Elevator Up – Your Success Journey

your mentors, your hard work. You have moved up in life, whether in career, finances, influence, or personal growth.

### 2. Sending It Back Down – Creating Pathways for Others

Once you are on a higher floor, do not just enjoy the view alone. Make it easier for others they could not open on their own.

### 3. Why This Matters

Because someone did it for you – Even if you worked hard, you also benefited from someone else's guidance, time, or belief in you.

Because success is sweeter when shared – True leadership is not measured by how far you go, but by how many you take with you.

Because it multiplies impact – When you help one person rise, they can help others in return.

My Take:

Success without significance is empty. If your climb only benefits you, it is a small legacy. That is how you create an impact that outlives you. I am not a mentor until I create other mentors.

Wangari Maathai planted trees not for herself but for future generations.

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Mother Teresa was not famous because she held a position of power or held major bank smallest acts, when done with love, can transform lives and change the world.

Here is how we can bring her wisdom into our own daily lives:

#### 1. Start Where You Are

worry about numbers. Help one person at a time and always start with the person nearest you.”

#### 2. See People, Not Problems

She did not just see poverty, she saw people. She looked into their eyes, called them by name, and treated them with dignity. In your world, slow down enough to truly notice people.

#### 3. Love Through Action

extended. Do not underestimate the power of these moments.

#### 4. Do Small Things Well

Mother Teresa believed that greatness is found in the quality of small acts. Fold the blanket neatly. Write the note thoughtfully. Show up on time. Excellence in small things builds trust and influence.

#### 5. Keep Your Heart Soft

The world can harden you if you let it. She chose compassion over cynicism, even in the toughest environments. Guard your heart so you can keep giving without bitterness.

Big impact does not require big titles or big money. It starts with doing small things with great will ever see.

Nelson Mandela's life teaches us that real leadership is not about power over people, it is about bringing people together and standing for what is right, even when it costs you everything.

Here is how we can live out his example:

#### 1. Choose Unity Over Division

Mandela understood that a divided nation cannot thrive. He worked to unite people across race, class, and politics. In your life, ask yourself: Am I building bridges or walls?

#### 2. Stand Firm for Justice

He spent 27 years in prison because he refused to compromise on equality. Justice sometimes unpopular.

Mandela forgave his oppressors, not to erase the past, but to create a future. Forgiveness is not

#### 4. Lead With Example, Not Just Words

He did not just preach unity, but he embodied it. His humility, discipline, and servant leadership made people follow him willingly. Your actions will always speak louder than your speeches.

#### 5. See the Bigger Picture

Mandela thought beyond his own comfort and lifetime. He worked for the freedom and dignity of generations yet unborn. That is the mindset of a true leader, and it brings boundless rewards.

Thought to Carry Forward:

family, workplace, or community, you can be the one who refuses to divide, stands for what is right, and leads with integrity. When you do this, the rewards in peace of mind and material riches will always follow you.

o Humility and selflessness as a foundation of service.

Humility & Selflessness – The True Foundation of Service

Real service is not about recognition or applause, it is about meeting needs, lifting others, and

making a difference without demanding the spotlight. Humility and selflessness are the bedrock of that kind of service.

### 1. Put the Mission Above Your Ego

When your goal is to serve, it is not about who gets the credit; it is about whether the need gets met. Focus on the mission, not on your image.

### 2. Listen More Than You Speak

Humility starts with listening. You cannot truly serve people if you do not understand their needs. Listen with an open mind, without rushing to give answers.

### 3. Share the Stage

Selflessness means creating space for others to shine. Give people credit for their contributions, celebrate their wins, and never be afraid to lift someone higher than yourself.

### 4. Serve Without Expecting Return

Service is most powerful when it is unconditional. Do not keep the score or wait for favors in return. The reward is in knowing you made an impact.

### 5. Stay Grounded, No Matter How High You Rise

Titles, positions, or wealth should never make you forget your roots. Stay approachable, relatable, and connected to the people you serve.

Major Take:

Humility keeps you grounded. Selflessness keeps you focused on others. Together, they make the service pure, powerful, and transformational. When you serve this way, you do not just help

Inspirational Quotes

When you succeed—when you reach higher levels in life—it is not just about you. It is also

The “elevator” is whatever took you to the next level—your skills, your opportunities,

to rise—through mentoring, sharing knowledge, creating opportunities, or opening doors

victory. But when you “send the elevator back down,” you turn your success into a

accounts. She is remembered because she lived a life of deep compassion—proving that even the

You do not need to wait for the “right time” or have a perfect plan. Mother Teresa said, “Never

Love is not just a feeling—it is a verb. A kind word, a listening ear, a meal shared, a hand

love—and doing them consistently. That is how you create ripples that reach farther than you

demand patience, endurance, and the courage to speak truth to power—even when it is

weakness—it is the strength to release bitterness so progress can begin.

people—you inspire them to serve too.

Reflection: Personal Introspection: “Who are you serving today and how?”

Stories & Examples

Unity and justice are not lofty ideals for history books—they are daily choices. Whether in your

Wisdom & Proverbs

{'text': 'The Proverb: “When You Take the Elevator Up, Send It Back Down for Others.”', 'link': 'https://www.google.com/search?q=The%20Proverb%3A%20%E2%80%9CWhen%20You%20Take%20the%20Elevator%20Up%2C%20Send%20It%20Back%20Down%20for%20Others.%E2%80%9D'}